

Chapter 15

Evidence

Chain of Custody

Tracks access to evidence

Records who handled data
and when

Maintains control of evidence

Prevents unauthorized access

Evidence Handling Process

Evidence collected in
controlled manner

Stored in collection containers

Access restricted to
authorized personnel

Documentation
maintained throughout

Data Integrity and Hashing

Integrity ensures
data unchanged

Hashing validates data integrity

Detects any alteration

Used in digital forensics

Hashing Behavior and Digest

Input produces unique
hash digest

Any change creates new digest

Even single-bit change
alters output

Acts as data fingerprint

Forensic Hash Usage

Created at investigation start

Used to verify data integrity later

Detects any modifications

Preserve original state

Legal Hold

Prevents deletion of data

Applies during legal cases

Ensures evidence retention

Protects relevant information

Data Retention and Preservation

Data retained for required time

Driven by
compliance requirements

Includes storage format
decisions

Part of data preservation process